



A VISITOR'S GUIDE TO WASHINGTON, D.C

Get inside the buildings you came to see

Tours, timelines and the real process -- compiled by a former congressional tour coordinator

Four Destinations, one unique process each



Monuments & Memorials

Photos, hours, and ticket links for every stop on the National Mall.



Capitol Tours

Staff lead vs. public tours and how to request each.



White House Tours

Request window, screening details and day of logistics.



Smithsonian Institution

Locations, timing, special exhibits and tickets.

How you should actually plan your DC trip

[See the full timeline](#) →

- 1

Pick Your Dates

Choose when you will visit the nation’s Capitol. Ideally you should start planning no less than 5 months in advance.
- 2

Send the request

Reach out to your Representative or Senator as far out as possible, but no less than 90 days prior to your trip. Some tours can be scheduled in less than 90 days, but 3 months is best!
- 3

Check your email

Many top destinations in DC require background screening to visit. These details are almost entirely requested through email. A missed email can lead to a missed tour!
- 4

Show up prepared

Bring a Real ID or passport. Many DC attractions now require them for entry! Pack and wear comfortable shoes, when walking between tours and attractions your feet will thank you!